The choice of the method of separation depends upon the properties of the components of the mixture. The separation method may be based on the particle's size, shape or physical state – solids, liquids or gases.

Filtering

Selvi's mother used a strainer to remove the tea leaves to get the clear liquid. Larger sized particles of tea leaves will be retained by the strainer while the clear liquid will pass through. This is called **filtering.**



Will you discard the tea leaves after straining? Can you suggest a good way of using them?

Sieving

A sieve is similar to a strainer. **Sieving** is used when we have to separate solid particles of different sizes. Eg: bran from flour, sand from gravel etc. Wire mesh as a strainer sieve is used to separate gravel from sand at a construction site.



Activity 6

Think and find, is it a good idea to separate bran from flour?

Churning

When very fine insoluble solids have to be separated from a liquid as in butter from curd, **churning** is performed.

The mixture is churned vigorously when solid butter will be collected on the sides of the vessel. Both butter and butter milk obtained after churning are useful and can be consumed.





In washing machines water is squeezed out from clothes and they are dried. This method is called centrifugation.

Threshing

When we pluck flowers from plants, we are separating the flowers from their

